

The Pony Post

A 4-week early reading program for preschool & pre-K — where the pony writes back.

A real pony visits your classroom four times. Between visits, she mails the children letters. Along the way, kids build vocabulary, learn how books work, count syllables with the pony's hooves, and learn how to safely be around a real horse — reading her body language the way we teach fire safety or bike safety.

FOR

Preschool & Pre-K, ages 3–5

EACH VISIT

25 minutes (one circle-time block)

BETWEEN VISITS

3 mailed "Pony Post" letters

FORMAT

4 weekly classroom visits

GROUP SIZE

Up to 15 children per visit

COST TO YOUR SCHOOL

Free (sponsor-funded)

Free to your school. The Pony Post is underwritten by a local sponsor, so there is no cost to the preschool or to families. Each child also receives a custom book to keep — *The Pony Goes to School* — delivered by the pony herself.

WHAT CHILDREN LEARN

- **20 new words** — 5 per visit, anchored to a real animal they touched
- **Print awareness** — books have a front and back, words go left to right
- **Listening & comprehension** — following and retelling a story
- **Rhyming & syllables** — counted out with the pony's hooves
- **Letter recognition** — the first letter of their own name
- **Real animal safety** — how to approach a horse and read her body language

THE 3 BIG RULES EVERY CHILD LEARNS

- **Inside voice** — ponies are prey animals; sudden noise scares them.
- **Walk, don't run** — quick movement startles a horse.
- **Tell the pony you're there** — a friendly "Hi, pony" so she always knows where you are.

A note on what this is. The Pony Post is an **educational reading and animal-safety program** built around a calm pony. It is not therapy, counseling, or treatment of any kind — just early literacy and real-world horse safety, taught in a way 3- to 5-year-olds love.

How the four weeks work

VISIT	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT KIDS PRACTICE
Week 1 <i>Meet the Pony</i>	The pony arrives wearing her Pony Express mailbag — "she has a job." Kids learn the 3 rules, how a pony sees, and how to read her ears, eyes, and tail. Gentle, one-at-a-time hello.	Vocabulary, print awareness, safe approach
Week 2 <i>The Mail Arrives</i>	The pony walks in with a mailbag full of books and delivers one to each child by name. Everyone follows along in their own copy of <i>The Pony Goes to School</i> .	First "reading," syllable counting, colors
Week 3 <i>Pony's Friends</i>	The pony introduces her ranch friends (a goat, a cat, another pony). Rhyming games and a favorite read-aloud about kindness and friendship.	Rhyming, story sequence, friendship words
Week 4 <i>The Big Day</i>	Meet Abby, a real Clydesdale — the biggest horse the kids have ever seen. Big vs. small, a letter-recognition game, a re-read of their book, photos, and take-home gifts.	Letter recognition, comprehension, opposites

BETWEEN EACH VISIT

The pony mails the class a letter, stamped and signed with a hoofprint, for the teacher to read aloud. It keeps the children connected to her between visits and gives them something to look forward to — and it reinforces that week's words and the 3 rules.

EVERY CHILD TAKES HOME

- Their own copy of *The Pony Goes to School*
- A "Pony Pals" sticker book
- A photo magnet of the pony
- A "Pony Express Rider" reader's pin
- A one-page note for families

THE 20 WORDS YOUR CHILDREN WILL PRACTICE

hoof · mane · tail · eye · soft · brown · white · hay · friend · gentle · share · kind · help · listen · breathe · big · small · together · ranch · goodbye

SAFE, INSURED, AND CLASSROOM-READY

- Only the calmest, kid-tested pony in the herd makes school visits.
- An adult chaperone always stays between the children and the pony.
- Tribal Cowboy carries liability insurance — a certificate is available on request.
- The pony brings her own mat, water, and hay; we clean up everything before we leave.

Want to bring the Pony Post to your school? Reach out and we'll walk you through scheduling, the sponsor, and a date that fits your calendar. Most preschools start in spring or fall.

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An Indigenous-owned equine experience serving North Idaho & Eastern Washington.